



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Friday, 1st August, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber of
Parliament at 11.12 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to the item numbered 5 – Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Reports*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I have in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 31st July, 2025, for correction. Hon Members, the floor is open for corrections.

Page 1...7—

Yes, Hon available Leader?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, given the fact that today is the last day, we are so happy. It is like “Our Day”

May I please make this observation and suggestion. The Tetteh family has been recognised, namely Philomena

Tetteh, Daniel Tetteh, Samuel, Cyril and Curtis, I suggest that we add the constituency they are coming from, so that, at least, we have a clue as to how to get them when the need arises.

Then, again, the Colonel in the item numbered 5(a)(vi), if we could assign his barracks or the unit he belongs to, that would also be helpful for the official record.

Mr Speaker, closely tied to that on the next page, though you are not there yet, with your kind indulgence, could we put the “Project Abroad” in a special quotation mark or any mark that highlights the name of the group itself.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, the *Votes and Proceedings* is supposed to capture the event that occurred. With regards to the item numbered 5(a), yesterday, we never added the constituency they were coming from. So, adding the constituency would have been introducing something new. We would not have captured what actually happened.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, properly understood, except to say that I was making a suggestion that, next time, if the Clerks-at-the-Table could highlight it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, at this stage, we are supposed to correct *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: With regards to the item numbered 5(b), it is exactly the way it is captured. These are people who are not living Ghana. We do not know their various constituencies and they announced their presence that they are coming from Brussels, Belgium, France, Germany and the United States of America (USA). So, the *Votes and Proceedings* is correct.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, respectfully, this particular group has been to the House before and it has been captured in our previous *Votes and Proceedings*; I mean the name Project Abroad—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you have the evidence of that?

Mr Afriyie: Yes, please. Mr Speaker, there is evidence that the name, Project Abroad, has been put in a special quotation mark. The Clerks-at-the-Table can check.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, let me hear you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, as much as what my Colleague is saying might make sense, it is alien to our Rules. It is alien to our Rules in the sense that the item numbered 5 says, “Recognition of Visitors”. These are not the only visitors who come to Parliament and we have not captured in any form where visitors, including the students who normally come—So, if we want to begin to itemise people and their constituencies, it would to be problematic. This is normally the form that the Clerks-at-the-Table do it.

Mr Speaker, to introduce what he is saying would be very alien to our Rules and I think that is the right way it should be captured and, for that matter, normally, that is how it is done. Other than that, when we do for this, it means that when any other visitor comes, we will be compelled to do what he is suggesting.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I have left out the item numbered 5(a) because I took your guidance. I introduced the item numbered 5(b)—And if you may, permit me to read:

“The Hon First Deputy Speaker recognised, in the Public Gallery, Members of Projects Abroad...”

My emphasis is on “Projects Abroad” and I said that it is a special group and this group has been to this august House before and, in recognition, the name of the group, Projects Abroad, had been put in a special quotation mark—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, for every acknowledgement that we make, this is the form that will indicate it. So, whatever is contained in this form is what the *Votes and Proceedings* will capture. I am having the same thing here and it is the same thing that would to read and after reading, I give it out. So, this is not an issue that we that we should belabour.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker, rightly so; you are right. When the visitors come, they give you a form and that is what you use to do the

recognition. So, you cannot introduce anything that is not given to you—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Who am I to determine that Projects Abroad should be in quotes or not.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we should not belabour too much on this. Let us make progress.

11.22 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 8...27—

[No correction was made to the Votes and Proceedings of Thursday, 31st July, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us look at the *Official Report* of Friday, 25th July, 2025. Hon Members, any correction?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have copies of that *Official Report*. I have checked on our table and the console, there is nothing like that. We do not have copies of the *Official Report* for 25th July, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, if it is not on the console, then on that note, we have to defer the consideration of this *Official* e. —We are talking about Friday, 25th July, 2025. It is on the console? It has even been distributed in our pigeonholes? Then we can proceed to have it corrected.

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, the *Official Report* is

actually here. It is not on the console, but I have a copy, and I think many of my Colleagues also have it. So, we can go ahead with that.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, then it means that it is only the Majority Side that has it. On our Side, we do not have that. I have checked.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Or was it distributed yesterday?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it was distributed one-sided. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Habib, can we go ahead to look at it? It is our own record.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker, we can.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 25th July, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the next item is the item numbered 6. Some Statements have been handed over. Before moving to the Statements, permit me to acknowledge our revered visitors.

We have students from New Generation Preparatory School in Asutifi South. They are 65 in number, and they are led by Amos Oppong Boateng, the Proprietor of the school.

On behalf of the Parliament of Ghana, I welcome you. May you have a fruitful visit. Thank you very much for coming.

[Pupils of New Generation Preparatory School were acknowledged]

Hon Members, the first Statement in my hand is standing in the name of Hon Kwaku Asante-Boateng, Member of Parliament for Asante-Akim South Constituency, on the tragic road accident around Juaso on the Accra-Kumasi Highway. Hon Member, you have the floor.

STATEMENT

Road Accident around Juaso on the Accra-Kumasi Highway

Mr Kwaku Asante-Boateng (NPP — Asante Akim South): Thank you Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I would like to make this Statement in connection with the road accident that occurred on the Accra-Kumasi Highway, specifically, within my Constituency.

Mr Speaker, as the Member of Parliament for Asante Akim South, I stand with a heavy heart to address the tragic road accident that occurred on 28th July, 2025, along the Accra-Kumasi Highway near Juaso Junction. This devastating incident claimed the lives of 16 members of the Obogu Saviour Church, who were returning from a youth conference in Osiem. Four others remained critically injured and are

receiving treatment at the Juaso Government Hospital.

Mr Speaker, the scale of this tragedy is unimaginable, particularly for the families of the Obogu Saviour Church, who bear an unbearable burden. The head pastor has lost two of his beloved children, while other parents in the congregation mourn the loss of two and even three of their own. All vibrant young persons aged between four and 21 were taken in an instant on that fateful day near Juaso Junction.

On behalf of the good people of Asante Akim South, I extend my deepest condolences to the bereaved families, the Obogu Saviour Church, the Obogu community and our entire constituency. This loss is devastating, and we mourn together as a community united in grief.

The accident was caused by a DAF XF fuel tanker with registration number GT-1674-17 which was moving from Kumasi to Tema. On reaching the section where the accident occurred at the Juaso Water Works, the driver decided to overtake some vehicles ahead using the middle lane without due consideration of vehicles from the opposite direction.

In the process, the left tire burst and he subsequently lost control of the steering wheel. This caused the driver to crash into an oncoming Ford Transit minibus with registration number GT-4674-22, which claimed the lives of 16 passengers. This underscores a persistent and deadly problem on the Atwedie-Juasoo stretch of the highway.

Mr Speaker, the stretch of the highway between Atwedie and Juaso Junction has over the years proven to be an accident hotspot, which has previously claimed a lot of lives, including one aspirant who was the parliamentary candidate for Shai-Osudoku.

Mr Speaker, according to recent statistics, apart from that, it was this same stretch that a motorcade of Rt Hon Speaker's convoy had an accident about a year ago. We also know of one Mr Jerry Adjei of Kotoko fame who died through an accident at the same spot about six years ago.

Mr Speaker, according to recent statistics, deaths through road accident in Ghana is on the ascendancy, rising from 1,237 in the first half of 2024, to 1,504 in the same period of 2025, representing a 21.6 per cent increase.

11.32 a.m.

This trend is alarming and underscores the need for a comprehensive approach to road safety. These are not just numbers; they are the heart and hope of families and their communities. We in this House hold the power to save lives and to prevent lives.

I urge the Government, the Ministry of Roads and Highways and the National Road Safety Authority to act swiftly: to install speed bumps, widen the deadly stretch, deploy traffic cameras and launch public education campaigns. I propose a task force to be formed within allocated timelines to ensure these

measures are implemented before more families suffer this fate.

Mr Speaker, our duty to the people of Asante Akim South and all Ghanaians at large is clear. How many more lives must we lose before we act? Let us honour the memory of these 16 souls by making our roads safe. This tragic loss has shattered Obogu, leaving scars that will endure for generations. We must channel this grief into action, ensuring no family endures such heartbreak tragedy again.

As the representative of the people of Asante Akim South, I pledge to work tirelessly with authorities to ensure our roads are safe for all users. The people of our Constituency and all Ghanaians deserve to be protected and travel without fear.

Mr Speaker, let us honour the memories of those who have lost by preventing further tragedies. May their souls rest in perfect peace and may their families find solace in the Almighty God. Let us all act now to preserve lives and posterity so that more families would not endure this pain in the future.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for giving me this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, a similar Statement is emanating from the Hon Member for Asante Akim North. The name is not stated, so you have the floor. Next time, include your name. After that, then we can take one contribution each and move on to other Statements.

Dr Ohene Kwame Frimpong: Mr Speaker, I am sorry; I have just got in here and I was not sure that I would be given the opportunity to read the Statement, but I have got it on my phone and I will pull it up now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I am sending you a copy of your Statement.

Dr Frimpong: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Acheampong?

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, respectfully, before the Hon Member comes in, if you would permit me, we want to vary the Business of the day and take the Motion numbered 9, so that we come back to the Statement. The Minister wants to step out, but he is here with us, so that we can take the Motion numbered 9, and then we continue with the Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, the Motion numbered 9.

Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah: Mr Speaker, please, it is actually 9 and 10, so if you would allow me.

Alhaji Habib Mr Speaker, we do not have any difficulty, except to give an indication that when the Minister moves the Motion to rescind the decision, he must give us the reason for which the House has to rescind that decision.

MOTION

Recission of the Mining Lease Agreement between GoG and Abosso Goldfields Limited

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House rescinds its decision taken on Thursday, 24th of July, 2025 in respect of the Resolution for the ratification of the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Mr Speaker, the reason for that is that in the Report, it was very clearly stated that Goldfield's one-year lease that comes to an end in April, should not be extended or transferred. Unfortunately, in the Resolution, it was not captured and we wanted to make sure that this earlier Resolution is rescinded, so that the new Resolution will capture properly the report that was submitted to the House. I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion moved, any seconder?

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I second the motion ably moved by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources and in

doing so, if you permit me, I will add a few comments.

The lease that was ratified by Parliament is a product of a lease that expired, and Goldfields applied to Government for an extension of the lease. Government declined to extend the lease and asked that the company winds up. That, therefore, called for a negotiation between Government and the company as to how the closure must be done.

In that negotiation, there was understanding between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and Goldfields, Abosso, that a one-year period be granted for the closure and cutbacks, in order that they will not come back to ask for any further extension of the lease. So, Mr Speaker, that was agreed, and as a consequence, a lease for a period of 12 months was granted Goldfields to enable them close up completely. So, in your Committee's Report, we provided, that this lease cannot be further extended beyond the expiry period in April next year.

We also said in your Committee's Report, that the lease cannot be transferred; it cannot be mortgaged, and it cannot be used for any transaction whatsoever and we felt that these important understandings that came up during the negotiation must be captured in the Resolution. We noticed that the 24th July Resolution lacked these important decisions, and therefore, the reason for the rescission of the original Resolution and the call for a new Resolution that will capture all the things

that we want to be captured in the Resolution as a decision of this House.

I thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, having listened to the Minister and the other briefings that I have gotten from my Colleague, I think it is a right decision to rescind that decision the House took earlier. Because this will go a long way to help the State, and it will not give Goldfields the opportunity to either extend or transfer it to a third party. So, for this one, I think the Minister was properly advised, and it is a mistake from the House. So, I think when we rectify it, it will go a long way to help the State.

11.42 a.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, I think it is clear; it is an internal error which is being corrected.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House rescinds its decision taken on Thursday, 24th of July, 2025 in respect of the Resolution for the ratification of the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso

Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, the item numbered 10. Hon Members, we are now proceeding to capture the correct proceedings.

RESOLUTION

Mining Lease Between GoG and Abosso Goldfields Limited

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

WHEREAS

1. By the provisions of Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;
2. In pursuance of the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Lands and Natural Resources a One-Year Transitional Mining Lease Agreement between the

Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region without the option of a further extension, transfer, mortgage or any other transaction after April, 2026.

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said One-Year Transitional Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region without the option of a further extension, transfer, mortgage or any other transaction after April, 2026.

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Mr Speaker, I wish to say that this Resolution captures the decisions taken by your Committee on Lands and Natural Resources, and I urge Colleagues to support this important Motion, which would be of benefit to all of us.

Question proposed.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I indicated earlier that this is very good

and in the right direction, that at the end of the day, if the right thing was not done and Parliament took a decision that would go against the state—The Minister and the Committee were able to bring their minds back to the fact that the country, Ghana, needs to benefit, and for that matter, we should not give a blind approval to the mining company, so that they cannot abuse the process.

This Resolution will now go to curtail and make it clear that the Gold Fields cannot go beyond the one year. They cannot transfer it to a third party, and at the end of the day, it will come back to the state. And the state will take a decision as to what we can now do for it.

So, I think it is something that is in the right direction, and for that matter, it is something that I support.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business, let us come to Order Paper *Addendum*.

Yes, Second Deputy Majority Whip?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not with us. I crave your indulgence to allow the Minister for Roads and Highways to lay the Paper on behalf of the Minister for Finance.

Hon Habib Iddrisu, today we are rising, and as I keep on advising, long talk and long stay in this Chamber is not good for our health. Today, we have decided to close early, so let us make things smooth so that we can leave this place very early.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we have a difficulty with the laying of this Paper. Apart from me just having one copy of the Order Paper *Addendum*, none of my Colleagues have a copy. And it is not on our console either.

So, Mr Speaker, let us continue with the Statement. When they do the right thing by distributing it, we can then lay it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order!

Hon Members, with all due respect, if you look at the single one that you have, it talks about the Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria. These are issues of health concern.

So, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, I may want to touch the soft part of your heart to allow this to go.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we have not engaged a lot on this issue. Let us do the right thing, then we can lay this Report.

Mr Speaker, as I said, my Members do not have copies of the *Addendum*. So let us continue with the Statement, when they make copies available, we can lay it. I am not saying we should not, but I am saying that let us do the right thing. It is not on the console.

Mr Speaker, Hon Acheampong, my Colleague, needs to do the needful. He needs to properly engage; he is not engaging. So, let us do the Statement and after the copies are given, we will come back and lay it. We all want to go home early today.

11.52 p.m.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I will continue to plead with my Colleague. Initially, I walked to him. I discussed the matter with the Leader himself, and he was there.

So, I will engage, but let us lay the Paper, so that the two of us will engage. I will invite him to attend the Committee meeting to a proper briefing. He will be well apprised. So, let us lay the Paper and continue with the Statement. I am just pleading with him. Today is Friday and I know he will go to the mosque.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am very happy that, at least, the former Deputy Minority Leader, who is now the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, and the former Minority Chief Whip, who is now the Minister for Roads and Highways, know that this is not new to the House. I am saying that I am not against it, but we know why the former Chief Whip said if other things

are laid here, there will be chaos. I do not want to use those words; those were his words.

Mr Speaker, let us just upload it. Now, I can see it on the console. Let us get copies and we will come back and lay it. It is not new. Mr Speaker, there are certain issues we cannot say this on the Floor, but we will engage with the Leader when they do the Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Deputy Chief Whip, let me understand you. If the issue before us is not new in the House, what then is the point?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Deputy Minority Chief Whip wants to hear me plead; I hereby plead. I have added my hands.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, since the Majority Leader pleaded, it is an indication that his numbers have deserted him, so we can go ahead and lay it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Minister for Roads and Highways?

PAPERS

By the Minister for Roads and Highways on behalf of the Minister for Finance —

Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to

Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria, 2011.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you have the floor. It is a joint Statement, so we take one comment each.

STATEMENT

Fatal Road Accident at Atwedie

Mr Kwame Ohene Frimpong (Ind — Asante Akim): Mr Speaker, I rise pursuant to Order 93 of the Standing Orders of this honourable House with, indeed, a burdened heart to make a Statement on behalf of the good people of Asante Akim North, following the tragic but avoidable road accident which occurred on Monday, 28th July, 2025, at around 14:00 hours on the Atwedie stretch of the Accra-Kumasi Highway.

Mr Speaker, 16 young lives were lost and I had the privilege to visit Hawa Memorial Saviour Hospital at Osiem yesterday in the mid-morning to visit four of the surviving members of the Saviour Church. I visited them; I saw them myself and they are doing quite well. The doctors there are doing very well and the nurses are doing their best.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you reading your Statement or are you making contributions?

Mr Frimpong: I am adding a bit to it because it is —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You cannot do that.

Mr Frimpong: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

These passengers, some of whom were my constituents, were returning to Obogu in the Asante Akim South Municipality after attending the annual conference of their church. Mr Speaker, I would say that Ghana does not suffer from lack of laws. We have the Road Traffic Regulation, 2012 (L. I. 2180); the Fatigue Management Regulations, and the licencing protocols.

Our challenge is the yawning chasm between legislation and enforcement and policy and actual protection. According to the National Road Safety Authority (NRSA), over 1,500 lives have been lost on our roads between January and June this year alone. What should disturb this House is not just the sheer numbers but the deafening silence and inaction that often follow such tragedies.

Mr Speaker, the cost of deferring reform is fatal. When road infrastructure is inadequate, it is the bones of ordinary Ghanaians that fracture under the weight of our collective inertia. Mr Speaker, even the reckless deserves systems robust enough to protect them. There must be no institutional or infrastructural gap wide enough for a fuel tanker to drift into an oncoming vehicle loaded with passengers.

Mr Speaker, let it be clear that I do not rise to suspend the Business of this honourable House. I rise because this is

the Business of the House. What more sacred responsibility do we bear than the protection of life and dignity? Mr Speaker, when we permit persistent inaction and normalise fatal neglect, we do not merely fail the bereaved; we fail the very purpose of governance. Every life lost on that highway is a resource stolen from the wealth of our Republic. If this House fails to act with urgency, then we are, by omission, complicit.

Mr Speaker, I wish to remind this honourable House that, in the 2025 budget of the Ministry of Roads and Highways, an amount of GH¢1.4 million has been allocated under the bridge line 0824157 for the section repairs of the Accra-Kumasi Highway. It is imperative that this allocation is not only disbursed, but utilised swiftly and effectively to address critical and dangerous portions of this key national corridor, particularly the Atwedie stretch, which has now claimed far too many lives.

Mr Speaker, I, therefore, call the Ministry of Roads and Highways to prioritise and expedite these repair works and all relevant agencies to provide regular updates on the progress. I also urge the NRSA and the Driver and Vehicle Licencing Authority (DVLA) to intensify public education and force traffic regulations without compromise and engage with transport unions to ensure safe practices.

Mr Speaker, on behalf of the people of Asante Akim North, I extend our deepest condolences to the families plunged into mourning. May their pain steer us

towards policy, infrastructure and institutional reforms that will honour the lives lost by protecting those yet to travel on our routes. May this tragedy not just pass as another headline but as a call to national action.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much, for this opportunity given. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you have the floor. Hon Members, we are taking just one contribution on each Side.

12.02 p.m.

Mr Davies Ansah Opoku (NPP — Mpraeso): Mr Speaker, I rise to express my deepest condolences to the families of the 16 young men and women who lost their lives on the Atwedie Road.

Mr Speaker, I share boundaries with Mr Asante Boakyee and, sometimes, if these things do not really affect someone, the person really will not appreciate the extent to which it damages society. Yesterday morning, I had an engagement with my Municipal Chief Executive (MCE). I called him and he said that most of the persons involved were his church members. So, he was going for the burial service.

Mr Speaker, this is sad and I am happy today that the Minister for Roads and Highways is here. I am a survivor of two near-fatal accidents on the Accra-Kumasi Road. In fact, ever since I had my last accident, I do not remember sleeping in my car while heading to my Constituency. I have a duty to always

travel from Accra to the constituency even in the evenings and what do we see, Mr Speaker? There are no lights; there are no roadside signages. In fact, there has not been an instance where you use the Accra-Kumasi Road and see policemen or Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA) officers checking for the roadworthiness of vehicles on that stretch.

And let us not politicise this. It has happened and there is no politics involved. Mr Speaker, we ought to save lives. I am happy that the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition announced that they were going to do mass solar lightening and all of that. I am urging the Minister for Energy and Green Transition and the Minister for Roads and Highways that the Accra-Kumasi Road leading to Tamale is a very critical road and almost every day, there is an incident being reported on that stretch; we want street lights on that road. We want street lights to save lives on that stretch.

Mr Speaker, we need to also look at how we dualise the road, especially from the Praso enclave heading towards Kumasi. The level of speeding amidst the curves on that stretch is alarming. It is something that we ought to do something about.

So, Mr Speaker, I am urging this House, the Minister and the President that as part of the Big Push Agenda, they should consider dualising that part of the road. It is too dangerous a road to always use. I use the road virtually every weekend when I am in the Constituency

trying to visit some of my areas. If you ply that road and come back, you need to say a prayer to thank God for saving your life. So, this is not just a Statement that should be swept under the carpet. This is a Statement that should awaken this very House and ensure that the Minister for Energy and Green Transition and the Minister for Roads and Highways do something on that stretch.

With these few words, Mr Speaker, I want to express my deepest condolence to the families of these 16 young people and also to the Members of Parliament from these areas; Asante Akim South and Asante Akim North. We pray that their gentle souls find a lasting peace in the bosom of our God.

Amen.

Mr Kwame Twumasi Ampofo (NDC — Sene West): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I would want to commend the Members of Parliament for Asante Akim North and South for this commendable Statement. It is very worrisome, that a lot of accidents happen due to our own mistakes or the mistakes of drivers. Mr Speaker, I extend my condolences to the families of those involved in this accident. May their souls rest in perfect peace. I saw the pictures and it is very worrisome.

Mr Speaker, these accidents are mostly due to the poor roads that we have in the country. I believe the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways is here and he is going to do his best to improve our road network; that will save the situation.

Mr Speaker, these accidents are also mostly due to unauthorised ramps on the road that cannot be identified. Poor road signs and non-existing road markings are also key causes. When moving in the night, you cannot see any markings especially during the rainy season. It is very challenging. Also, accidents occur due to poor lighting system on our roads. Mr Speaker, a lot of drivers also overspeed and do wrong overtaking where there are curves or hills. Even though they cannot properly see ahead of them, they still do overtake. Mr Speaker, some cars also do not have reflectors at the back of their cars and the police have to check them because, Mr Speaker, on the highway, one might be driving at a certain speed and suddenly encounter a car broken down in the middle of the road. Mr Speaker, if care is not taken, one will definitely hit the car and the person might lose their life.

Mr Speaker, another cause of accidents is wrong signals of some of the drivers when they are driving. Some drivers can signal left while they are going right and if one does not take care, one will definitely hit the person or there will be an accident. Also, drink driving; some drivers will drink and drive. It is a dangerous thing and the police must check them. Also, sleepwalk-driving is more dangerous than drink-driving. When one is sleepy while driving, it is better to park aside and take rest or sleep for some time and continue.

Mr Speaker, lack of car maintenance is another cause of accidents. Some drivers have poor brakes that they do not fix and some also drive cars with poor lights.

The drivers cannot see well, yet they do not want to fix them. So, Mr Speaker, all these things need to be taken care of.

Mr Speaker, some drivers have poor sight and they need to get their sight properly checked. They cannot see well. All of these cause accidents. Some cars have bad tyres that need to be fixed.

Mr Speaker, in concluding, I had an experience where a certain car's tyre was not good but the owner wanted the driver to take the people to some convention. The driver said, unless the owner changed the tyre, he was not moving the car. They went ahead and most of them died.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will now proceed to give the floor to Hon Fiifi Buckman, Member of Parliament for Kwesimintsim to give a Tribute to the late Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley.

Hon, you have the floor.

Tribute to the Late Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman (NDC — Kwesimintsim): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to make this Statement to eulogise a patriot of our land who would finally join his ancestors tomorrow, 2nd August, 2025. Mr Speaker, Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley, (popularly known as Uncle Sam or Sam Pee) was the mighty brain behind the founding of the National Democratic

Congress (NDC) Professionals Forum (ProForum). Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley was more than a founding member. He was the heartbeat of a bold and transformative idea that professionals within the NDC must arise and lend their voice and expertise to shape the national discourse.

With unshakeable conviction and remarkable leadership, he built a movement that transformed the narrative. He made the NDC honourable and even enviable and contributed towards public support for the party.

Mr Speaker, like various philosophers and political thinkers, such as Thomas Hobbes, John Locke, Dr Kwame Nkrumah, Julius Nyerere, the late Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley, with his mobilisation acumen, added to our democracy an actionable and achievable political strategy worthy of emulation in building our democracy.

Mr Speaker, the late Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley was a beacon of brilliance, humility and empathy.

12.12 p.m.

He was calm in adversity and gifted in resolving conflicts with wisdom, a natural consensus builder. He empowered others and led clarity, always pursuing unity in the pursuit of shared goals. Mr Speaker, a chunk of his life was dedicated to service to Ghana as the Chief Executive Officer of the National Pensions Regulatory Authority, till 2014.

He was an astute lawyer in good standing till his demise. He was a customary family head and believed in the customs and traditions of his people, and was rooted with his people in the Central and Ahanta land. Mr Speaker, Ambassador Sam Yalley was not just a leader, he was the embodiment of the values we need to uphold, unity, service, courage and purpose.

He was later appointed as Ghana's Ambassador to India. His tenure in New Delhi marked a significant period in the Ghana-India relationship. His advocacy and lobbying ability inured to the benefit of Ghana from India, increased investment interest in Ghana and expanded educational and cultural exchanges.

He was a great advocate for female leadership and gender equity, and through that he nurtured many ladies who currently occupy high public offices and are performing credibly.

His calm demeanour, incisive commentary and great sense of fairness in both political, economic and legal discourse earned him great respect and love across political divides. He was loved by both young and old and treated all men with utmost respect and inspired greatness wherever the opportunity availed.

Mr Speaker, to conclude, may I humbly quote a verse in Methodist hymn book, 896. It says:

“Now praise we great and famous men,
The fathers named in story;
And praise the Lord who now as then,
Reveals in man His glory.”

May his gentle soul rest in perfect peace. Thank you very much Mr Speaker for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before taking the contribution, I do not know whether we should combine this with a Statement on Ali Jarrah.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think we should just take the Statement and then we can do the contribution because our Leaders are ready for us to wrap up for today. And you indicated that it is your pleasure for us to finish early. So, if you can take the Statement and then we will just take the contribution.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, there is also another Statement standing in the name of Jerry Ahmed Shaib. Hon Member, you have the floor.

Neglect of Former U-17 Goalkeeper, Ali Jarrah

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib (NPP—Weija/Gbawe): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for this opportunity. Mr Speaker, Ali Jarrah is alive and kicking. I am excited the Minister of Sports and Recreation is here for him to perhaps consider my Statement in its entirety.

Mr Speaker, I rise today to bring to the attention of this august House a matter of

grave concern and national shame - the systematic neglect and abandonment of one of Ghana's greatest football legends, Ali Jarrah, whose sacrifice for our beloved nation has been met with decades of indifference from the very institutions that should have been his strongest pillars of support.

Mr Speaker, Ali Jarrah is not just any ordinary Ghanaian; he is a national treasure whose name should be etched in gold in the annals of Ghana's sporting history. This remarkable goalkeeper was the backbone of Ghana's golden generation that brought unprecedented glory to our nation in the early 1990s. As a member of the 1991 Black Starlets, Jarrah was instrumental in Ghana's historic victory at the FIFA U-17 World Cup in Italy, where his exceptional goalkeeping skills helped secure Ghana's first-ever FIFA World Cup triumph at any level.

Mr Speaker, Jarrah's excellence extended beyond the 1991 triumph. He was a key figure in Ghana's impressive run to the silver medal at the 1993 FIFA U-20 World Cup Championships in Japan and contributed to Ghana's silver medal success at the African U-17 Championship in Mauritius in 1993.

At the club level, Jarrah distinguished himself as the first-choice goalkeeper for Accra Hearts of Oak, where his performances in the 1992/1993 season earned him all three major awards that season. The trajectory of this sporting icon's career was pointing toward international stardom, with reported interest from prestigious European clubs

including my team, Liverpool FC and FC Köln of the German Bundesliga.

Mr Speaker, however, fate had other plans, and in 1993, during a highly charged Super Clash between Hearts of Oak and Asante Kotoko *Wo kum apim a apim beba*, Ali Jarrah sustained a career-ending injury that would fundamentally alter the course of his life forever. The injury that befell Ali Jarrah in 1993 was not merely a sporting mishap; it was a life-altering catastrophe that left him paralyzed and stripped him of his livelihood while he was serving Ghana in the line of duty. For 17 long years, this national hero has borne the physical, emotional, and financial burden of that fateful day, with his hope gradually fading as he faces continued neglect and indifference from the state.

The treatment of Ali Jarrah by Ghana's sporting institutions represents one of the most shameful chapters in our nation's sporting history. The Ministry of Sports and Recreation has turned a blind eye to Jarrah's plight for over three decades, failing woefully in its duty of care toward one of the nation's most celebrated athletes. Similarly, the Ghana Football Association has shown a disturbing lack of gratitude and responsibility. Despite Jarrah's emotional appeals for recognition and justice, his calls for acknowledgment have gone unheard for 17 years.

The government's inaction in this matter is equally deplorable. While we celebrate our sporting achievements and bask in the glory brought by our athletes on international stages, we have failed to

establish comprehensive support systems for those who suffer life-altering consequences while representing Ghana.

Despite the overwhelming challenges and institutional abandonment, Ali Jarrah has demonstrated remarkable resilience and determination to rebuild his life. Rather than succumb to despair, he has channelled his energy into chalk production, establishing a small business that serves as his primary source of livelihood. This entrepreneurial venture represents not only his personal struggle for economic survival, but also his unwavering spirit and refusal to be defeated by circumstances beyond his control.

The Ministry of Education presents a unique opportunity to provide meaningful support to Ali Jarrah while simultaneously addressing practical needs within our educational system. Given that Jarrah has established himself in chalk production - a commodity essential to our educational infrastructure - there exists a perfect synergy between supporting this sporting legend and meeting genuine educational requirements.

I call upon the Ministry of Education to engage with Ali Jarrah's chalk production enterprise and provide the necessary financial and logistical assistance to expand his operations. This partnership could include bulk purchasing agreements, equipment provision, technical training, and market linkage support that would transform Jarrah's small-scale operation into a thriving enterprise capable of serving

educational institutions across the country.

The government must establish a comprehensive support system for former athletes who have suffered career-ending injuries while representing Ghana. This should include medical care, financial assistance, entrepreneurial support, and recognition programmes that acknowledge their contributions. As the Minister for Sports and Recreation is here, I call his attention on this matter.

12.22 p.m.

The Ghana Football Association must acknowledge its moral obligation to Ali Jarrah and take immediate steps to provide him with the recognition, financial support, and medical assistance he deserves.

Mr Speaker, let Ali Jarrah's story be the last of its kind in Ghana's sporting history. Let us honour our past heroes while protecting our future ones. Let us demonstrate that Ghana truly values those who sacrifice everything for the honour and glory of our beloved nation. The measure of a nation's character is reflected not only in how it celebrates its heroes during their moments of triumph but also in how it cares for them during their times of need. Our sporting heroes who lose their source of livelihood while carrying Ghana's flag deserve our unwavering support, not our neglect. They deserve recognition, not abandonment. They deserve dignity, not despair. The time for action is now.

Mr Speaker, while I finally conclude, as President of the Ghana Weightlifting Federation, we are also scheduled to host the African Youth Junior Championship that is supposed to come off—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is that part of your Statement?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I am only asking your permission just to sum up.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, the Rules are clear; you are supposed to read the Statement that has been admitted for you.

Mr Shaib: I respectfully end my Statement by saying that let us pay attention to our heroes, and not to neglect them.

Thank you very much and God bless us all.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation?

Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to make comments on the two Statements that have been made by our Colleagues. The first one has to do with Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley.

Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley was one person I closely worked with. Many are aware that the genesis of my politics is from the Central Region, so I worked so closely with Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley in many projects in the Central Region. I continued and became a

national officer of the Party and he equally was in the national level. So, we continued to work together.

The very recent and last project we did was organising the Party's national congress. We were members of the committee and I chaired that committee. We worked together. At all times, Ambassador would call and would drive to my office in Parliament just for us to have discussions because he wanted us to deliver one of the best congresses ever.

Like the Statement indicated, he was the founder of the Professional Forum and this became established when I was the then national organiser. Many did not understand what that was intended for, but I knew the benefits it would bring, not just to the NDC but to our politics. This is because we need the involvement of the professionals in the politics of our country. And truly so, the NDC and the political space have benefited from the creation of such a group in our party.

The family has lost a great person; the NDC has lost a great person; the country has lost a great person. I would say may his soul rest in perfect peace.

Mr Speaker, commenting on the Second Deputy Minority Whip's Statement on Ali Jarrah, it is true that our sports persons and sports icons must be celebrated, but this has not been done over the years. I remember very well how the former goalkeeper of the Black Queens was virtually thrown out and not cared for or attended to. It took H.E. John Dramani Mahama then to intervene about three years ago in getting her

accommodation. We should not allow our heroes and heroines to go through such a situation.

Ali Jarrah has not been abandoned though by the state. But if there are other things that he needs and some other things that can be done for him, I believe that there are ways that we can carry these through. Currently, His Excellency the President's Cabinet has given approval for establishment of a Sports Fund and this Fund would also go a long way to support athletes and athletes' development and also the former athletes when they retire. We are working very hard to even get the involvement of SSNIT and insurance companies in some of these projects. One insurance company has submitted a proposal to me as pathway of solving some of these emergency challenges that will occur in the course of their businesses.

Mr Speaker, support to leagues so that clubs can also support football and footballers especially. Just yesterday, we launched an arrangement that the Ghana Football Association (GFA) and Adesa Productions Limited (APL) have come into. Government is mobilising resources from private and public corporates to make sure we fund this project for the telecasting of games and also running of the games. So, there will be much more money available to take care of these players to reduce some of the stress that they go through.

Mr Speaker, I dare say that our Ministry is sensitive, aware and awoken to its responsibilities. And that was why arrears of coaches that have been left

unpaid from 2020 till I took over as a Minister have been cleared. As we speak, we do not owe any former coach. Coaches that were sacked, coaches that were dismissed and were not paid, we have made sure we have cleared all these and we will continue on that.

We will look into the Ali Jarrah issues and see what it is that we can do first as a Ministry and Government and I also invite the corporates. In many parts of the world where we see athletes' welfare being taken very good care of, private corporates have been involved. We are not seeing much happening in Ghana and I think that this is a challenge to all of us. As Members of Parliament (MPs), when we go to our constituencies, let us speak. When we engage the corporates, let us remind them. Let us know that they have a way to contribute to better the lot of our athletes.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to assure the House that I have taken note of the Statement. I will pick it up and engage Ali Jarrah and see what we can do to help him.

Thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I will give the floor to Hon Darko-Mensah.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Thank you very much. Special regards to those two Statements. Mr Speaker, I would like to start with Hon Sam Pee Yalley. As a child, we had known Sam Pee Yalley as an Assemblyman in Dansoman, around the SSNIT Flats. He was so

popular that when he even transitioned into the NDC politics, people said they did not know that this was the man.

Mr Speaker, as a westerner, and Sam Pee Yalley being an Ahanta, he is one of the few politicians in our area whose politics was very solid and quiet. I still remember his humility in dealing with issues. I knew him very well because of the relationship we had with some of his nieces and nephews, the Oduro family of Takoradi.

We were very close to their grandmother, Mrs Akoto. But one thing about Sam Pee Yalley was that, as an Ambassador, he was able to reach out to a lot of Ghanaians in that community in India. I quite remember my own operational director, Justice Acquah had worked with him in India during those days when he was an Ambassador, Ghana's High Commissioner to India.

Mr Speaker, if we also take his family politics in the Ahanta area, I worked with Hon Sam Pee Yalley when I was the Regional Minister on the 50th Anniversary of Nana Baidoo Bonsoe, the Ahantahene. Even though the programme did not come up, I could see his humility, his sense of urgency, and his sense of connectedness to his people and to making sure that everything that we were doing in the Western Region, he was always in the loop.

Hon Sam Pee Yalley has done so well for this country at National Pensions Regulatory Authority (NPRA) as ambassador.

12.32 p.m.

If you look at even his public discourse on politics, he was not always the angry type. He was always looking for solutions to the common problems of this country and, for that reason, I believe that he is one person who we need to commend.

Mr Speaker, on the issue of Ali Jarrah, when we were children, I think Ali Jarrah was more of our hero till he got sick. If you look at the issues that are coming up in supporting our artists, I believe that is something that we need to set up and work at it and make sure that the systems work. It is not just setting up funds. Most of the time, we set up the funds and they just do not work.

Mr Speaker, I believe that the Minister has brought up a key issue about the private sector supporting these funds and supporting artists. One of the critical problems we have in this country is that the business community want to support, but Government also has to support the business community to be doing well and then our ability as a country to create more businesses or the enabling environment for us to have more businesses, so that the more and the less each of them pay, when we accumulate them, becomes huge for us to be able to do the work that we have to do.

These are some of the issues that I believe we need to look at. Because if the money is not generated in the first place, the business community cannot support in areas that Government cannot do well so much.

With these few words, Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Alhaji Collins Dauda (NDC — Asutifi South): I will begin by commending the Member of Parliament (MP) for Kwesimintsim Constituency for putting this Statement together, eulogising one of us, Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley. Sam Pee Yalley, as I affectionately called him, was a man full of humour; he was down to earth, a unifier, and, importantly, a very strong organiser.

I met Sam Pee Yalley first at the Consultative Assembly when Ghana took the decision to transit from the military regime to a civilian regime and took up democracy as the way to govern this country. The then Government put together a Consultative Assembly and tasked the Assembly to come up with a draft constitution. That was when I met Sam Pee Yalley; as a young person then, he was very humorous and worked hard at the Consultative Assembly, which put together the 1992 Constitution. I thought that the Statement should have captured that important part he played for Ghana.

Sam Pee Yalley, as I have indicated, played several roles in the formation of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) as a young man and he continued to support the NDC and played various roles in the NDC until his demise. It is my wish that Allah accepts his soul in heaven. May Ambassador Sam Pee Yalley rest in perfect peace.

Mr Speaker, with regards to Ali Jarrah, the situation that has been described to us

by the Second Deputy Minority “witch” is not different from the situation of other people who have served this country. While I support the position taken by—*[Interruption]*—Mr Speaker, by accident, I referred to him as a “witch”—*[Laughter]*—It was by accident and I humbly withdraw.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Dauda: I tried to say Second Deputy Minority Whip.

Mr Shaib — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: He has corrected himself. Yes, he has withdrawn it.

Alhaji Dauda: Mr Speaker, I fully support the position taken by the Hon Member that Ghana must take care of people who have served this country as sportsmen and politicians. If you look at the sports space, you can talk about so many people who lack so many things even though they have played key roles in the sporting arena. In the same vein, if you look at us, the politicians, we also face the same situation. We have former Ministers who look very miserable and the same with former MPs. It is as if they have never served this country before.

And I thought that a scheme should be put in place to take care of our people who have served this country and served this country very well. Otherwise, it may not be useful to serve this country. Therefore, I am of the view that, as a country, we need to have a scheme to identify such people and support them

when they age in order that it will serve as a motivation for others to also work hard and put their lives down for this country.

I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the indication is that we would take one Statement each from each Side.

Very well. Then, I would proceed to give the floor to the Hon Minority Leader for his concluding remarks.

Closing Remarks

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, thank you very much. Let me begin my closing remarks for this Second Meeting of the First Session of this Ninth Parliament with a quote from K. Kudjo who wrote on the role of Minority in our democracy.

Mr Speaker, this is what this writer had to say about democracy and I quote:

“The true measure of democracy is not the muzzle of the Majority; it is the backbone of the Minority. When power grows too comfortable, even a Minority of one must rise. Their role is not to decorate debate but to disrupt decay. They are not seed fellers. They are the guardrail of the republic. Every bold promise must be tested. Every flashy decision must answer to the people. Ghana is done with hollow rhetoric. The new citizen is alert, informed, and allergic to excuses. The

Minority may be few, but their mandate is undiminished. Ghana still expects them to deliver”.

12.42 p.m.

Mr Speaker, with this, a Minority in this House feels inspired to continue its work and to deliver on this mandate of the people. Mr Speaker, and we do so with a deep spirit of responsibility, reflecting on the significant development that have taken place both within the walls of this Parliament and in the broader governance space of our Republic. Parliamentary Business is often complex, but critical to the sustenance of our democracy, and this meeting undoubtedly has been marked by various events that have tested the strength of our democratic resolve.

Mr Speaker, in delivering these remarks, permit me to pay a solemn tribute to our dear colleague and patriot, the late Hon Ernest Yaw Kumi, Member of Parliament for Akwatia, who sadly passed away on 7th July, 2025. His untimely departure is not only a personal loss to those of us who knew and worked with him, but a national tragedy that has robbed this House of a vibrant, promising legislator. May his soul rest in perfect peace.

Mr Speaker, in the course of this Meeting, the Minority acted with a deep sense of responsibility and urgency. We have carried the burdens of our people, raised their concerns on this Floor, kept alive the flickering flame of democratic accountability.

Mr Speaker, the Constitution enjoins Parliament not merely to legislate, but to scrutinise, to question and to ensure accountability in the use of public resources. Over the course of this Meeting, the Minority has been steadfast in holding the Executive to account. We demonstrated with clarity that power is not a licence for impunity, the clarity that Parliament must not be reduced to a rubber stamp, and the clarity that where the Majority falters, it is the Minority that must stand firm and speak the truth, regardless of the costs. We in the Minority have not shirked that responsibility.

In this Meeting, we filed several Urgent Questions to Ministers to demand answers on pressing issues affecting the daily lives of Ghanaians. Answers about the cost of living, answers about the state of our hospitals, about the collapse of local industries, about the pain of ordinary Ghanaian citizens whose dreams have been battered by a government that is increasingly distancing itself from the private sector.

Again, Mr Speaker, in this Chamber today, we have a newly elected Member of Parliament for Ablekuma North, but we all know the event that led to this eventual election. The Minority hereby reiterates its stand against the Electoral Commission for the sudden U-turn that robbed Hon Akua Afriyie of her deserving victory. That said, we also say that the event that eventually brought our respected Colleague into this Chamber must not be glossed over. The violence and the misconduct that met the re-run in Ablekuma North sadly bears a stain of

electoral violence, and that stain cannot be ignored. The intimidation, aggression, embracing violation of the laws that we witness have no place in our democracy.

To the newly sworn Member of Parliament (MP), we say this, your first test is before you; demand justice, call for accountability, work to ensure that no political affiliation shields anyone from prosecution, send a clear, unambiguous message that Ablekuma North will not be a haven for political violence. Defend the democracy that brought you here by demonstrating zero tolerance for political violence.

Mr Speaker, the Minority also stood firm in resisting the legislative overreach of the Majority. For the record, permit me to reiterate the sentiment I expressed in my opening remarks prior to the vetting of the last batch of the Deputy Ministerial Nominees:

“In every functioning democracy, fairness in parliamentary practice is not a matter of convenience, it is a constitutional imperative. The legitimacy of representation rests not on the brute force of the numbers, but on the integrity of the processes through which those numbers are interpreted and applied. It is not the majoritarian muscle that gives Parliament its soul, but the enduring principles of balance, precedence, and the inclusion of Minority voices in decision-making. Parliamentary politics, then, is not merely a numbers game. Yes, numbers matter, but principles matter more. At its core, Parliament is a moral contract,

a shared understanding that power must be exercised with restraint, and that electoral victory, no matter how decisive, must never become a licence for institutional overreach or unchecked dominance”.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Caucus in this Ninth Parliament has time and again wielded its numerical strength not as a mandate to shape and enrich debate, but we have often seen this as being used as a weapon to impose its will on the House. A clear example is their increasing reliance on certificates of urgency for every Bill to railroad legislation, sidestepping due diligence and undermining Parliamentary scrutiny, and eroding the oversight role that is so essential to our democracy.

We have witnessed on multiple occasions the Majority bulldozing its way through decision-making processes, with scant regard for consensus or constructive engagement but democracy is not about majoritarian tyranny; it is about balance, inclusion and accountability. The dangerous precedents being set by the Majority, where power is exercised without restraint, must not be encouraged. We would encourage our Colleagues to bear with us, even as we put forward our argument to scrutinise. They must not see it as frustrating them, but they should see it as our bid in enriching Parliamentary democracy.

Mr Speaker, Government has time and again been compelled to reverse unlawful or ill-conceived actions after the Minority raised the alarm. On the so-

called *dumsor* levy, we welcomed the suspension, but surprisingly, Government used a backdoor to implement it to further burden the people of Ghana. We reiterate that we support any attempt at ensuring reforms at Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG). We do not agree to the imposition of levies and taxes. Within these six months alone, Government has increased the levies and imposed burden on Ghanaians when it comes to electricity consumption and we know that the people deserve better. We support reforms and would urge Government to come forward with reforms rather than imposing taxes.

Mr Speaker, it is very troubling that within this short period, a lot of businessmen are facing crisis because they are being targeted in one way or the other. The Minority wonders why foreign businesses are doing well, but Ghanaian businesses have become targets of certain state institutions.

Mr Speaker, the recent attack on the warehouse of McDan is something that we should all condemn. It is not proper for a country to see the unleashing of state security on the private business of a Ghanaian, whereas there is no single foreign business in our country suffering from such attacks from state institutions. This must end. We should encourage our own and support our own. We should build our Ghanaian industry and not subject them to partisan affiliations. It will not help our country.

To our friend, McDan, I say to him, though he is one of the Ghanaian businessmen who has done so much,

created jobs, yet is going through this. We pray that the good Lord Himself will comfort him in this difficult moment, as well as all those businesses that have become subject to attacks because some people feel they are affiliated with one political party or the other.

12.52 p.m.

Mr Speaker, on *galamsey*, this Government has become a tragedy before our very eyes. There is a complete breakdown of the fight against illegal mining. *Galamsey* is now worse. This Government has completely failed in its fight against *galamsey*. Our rivers are polluted, our forests are vanishing, and our children are drinking poisoned water. Yet those who promised to end *galamsey*, as soon as they were voted into office, they have become the chief enablers.

On May Day, the Trade Union Congress, TUC, publicly condemned the NDC Government's weak, half-hearted approach to tackling illegal mining. And what did they get in return? Verbal abuse, baseless accusations of partisanship, and vile attacks from the NDC's communicators. They were not alone. The University Teachers' Association, UTAU, also added a voice to the national outcry. UTAG has issued a stark ultimatum. If President Mahama fails to honour the anti-*galamsey* pledge he voluntarily signed before the 2024 election, they will embark on a strike action. The Catholic Bishops' Conference has also boldly added a voice on this matter. Government must take action.

And if indeed the Government is determined, this Side of the House, the Minority, is ready to support this Government to deal with the issue of *galamsey*. Mr Speaker, the consequences of the Government's negligence are not abstract. Doctors are now sounding the alarm over a spike in gallbladder-related diseases in communities affected by *galamsey*. This is not just an environmental crisis. It is a growing public health emergency. And what is the Government doing about it? Nothing meaningful. We urge the President to unmask and prosecute all those profiting from this destruction.

Mr Speaker, let me now turn my attention to the Gold Board issue. Mr Speaker, Civil Society Organisations have sounded the alarm that a significant portion of the gold being procured by the Gold Board is reportedly sourced directly from illegal *galamsey* operations. The Gold Board was to purchase gold and generate foreign exchange in support of the cedi. Its mandate is fundamentally commercial, but it also bears a critical ethical responsibility to ensure that the gold it procures comes from legitimate and responsible sources. And herein lies a crisis.

We have tasked a commercial entity with a mandate that directly conflicts with our national environmental priorities. How do we ensure that the Gold Board's drive to shore up the cedi does not come at the expense of our lands, rivers and future? The conflict of interest is glaring. Economic gain versus environmental integrity. So long as we

create incentives for gold sourced from illegal mining, we are not fighting *galamsey*; we are funding it. And the Government must take note of this.

This House must demand accountability and transparency from the Gold Board and insist on mechanisms to verify responsible sources. Anything less would rather increase the situation and worsen it.

Mr Speaker, let me now deal with the issue of the unrest in Bawku. Mr Speaker, we have witnessed an alarming surge in insecurity, including spill-over of the Bawku conflict that tragically claimed the lives of students in Nalerigu and Bawku.

Mr Speaker, fortunately for us, the Leader of the House is the Member of Parliament (MP) for Bawku. I call on this House to avoid making this a partisan matter. Let us pray for peace in Bawku. Let us reach out and encourage all stakeholders who have been given the mandate to mediate to do their work. Let us guide our utterances and ensure that there is peace in that part of our country.

Mr Speaker, when peace is attained in Bawku, it will have positive, spiral effects on other areas in the country. Conflict in other countries starts in such a manner, and with time, it just gets out of hand. We must not allow Bawku to get out of hand. And I want to assure my respected colleague, the Majority Leader, that I will always remember him in my prayers. I can just relate to it. If it were my Constituency, how would I even go there and all? As well as other

constituencies in the Kusawgu area, I pray for peace for them and I say that their Colleagues in this House are here supporting them in prayers and we believe that with concerted efforts, our country would experience peace and their people would also experience peace for development to take place there.

Mr Speaker, let me deal with the issue of the attack on our journalists, the media. Mr Speaker, recently, the Ghana Journalists Association's (GJA) President had cause to express concern about what is happening to journalists. The assaults of not fewer than 12 journalists have become of grave concern to the Ghana Journalists Association. Mr Speaker, the Executive must speak out and end this. Now, let me also turn to the state institutions that are involved in investigations.

Mr Speaker, this Side of the House, the Minority, is never against accountability. But we want to say to the state agencies to execute their mandate with a human face. We are seeing situations where, Mr Speaker, bail is being used as punishment. The Economic and Organised Crime, EOCO, for instance, is—[pause]

1.02 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, please address the Chair.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, today we see EOCO granting bail with onerous conditions. Suspects are being demanded to provide valued title

documents, and it is done such that the person will remain days in custody.

Mr Speaker, we have to watch some of these. As a country, if we do not find space to end bitterness and revenge, it will continue. Today, it is the NDC in office. The NDC will not be in power forever. If something happened yesterday, it is time for us to end it. Because, Mr Speaker, tomorrow, for those who are occupying positions, they should remember that if they do not control and check some of these things, it may be difficult for the moderates in the opposition party to control those hawks when that time comes.

It is time to end the bitterness, the revenge, and the pain. We are a country of one people. If the hawks will continue to dictate to governance, so be it, but we will leave it to see.

Mr Speaker, I cannot gloss over what is happening to our Judiciary; our Chief Justice is being hounded. The ongoing situation involving the suspended Chief Justice raises serious concerns. The process lacks transparency and is being cloaked in so much secrecy. The public is left in the dark, and the questions are mounting about the selective justice, political witch hunt, and the shielding of party loyalists.

The Judiciary must never be reduced to a battlefield for political score settling. The Attorney-General's recent conduct raises serious concerns about the politicisation of justice.

We are witnessing a troubling pattern of selective prosecution, where political opponents are swiftly targeted while allies of the Government are shielded from accountability. This blatant double standard undermines public confidence in the justice system and threatens the rule of law at its core. Today, there is a new word in town, “60/40”.

Mr Speaker, before I bring my remarks to a close, let me touch on a matter that occurred in this House on 22nd July, 2025. On 21st July, 2025, I attended the Northern Development Conference. I left home at dawn to honour the invitation of the Majority Leader. I returned very fatigued, but I still had to come to the House. I was taken ill in the early hours of 22nd July, 2025, and while on my hospital bed, watching the television (TV), I witnessed an event on this very Floor, which left me very sad.

Mr Speaker, I found it very strange that after the Committee of Selection had taken a decision to table a Motion regarding composition of delegation to Pan-Africa and ECOWAS Parliaments, two events took place on the floor of this House. One, on Pan-Africa, after both Leaders had discussed at length on the issue of Pan-Africa, I found it strange that a Motion was moved that gave the New Patriotic Party (NPP) Minority, one seat with an observer status.

The formula we agreed on this Floor was to give us two seats. So, what was given to us was not a favour; our rights were denied us. I am saying that this must never happen. We demand that the

Majority must revisit this matter and ensure that the right thing is done. This is a House of precedents.

Mr Speaker, on the ECOWAS situation, the situation was worse. The Leader of the House rose and moved the Motion to vary the delegation, ostensibly taking my name out. I found this very strange. I am a member of the ECOWAS Parliament, duly sworn in with a fixed mandate of four years. I am also a Deputy Speaker of ECOWAS Parliament.

Mr Speaker, internally, our Side had done our own arrangement and although Leaders normally go to Inter Parliamentary Union (IPU) and Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA), my Deputy and I had discussed and she had taken the slot for IPU and CPA. It would also interest one to know, that as a Leader, I am not on any Committee in this Parliament, apart from our statutory Committees. So for an impression to be created that the Deputy Minority Leader is being cheated, and that the Majority Leader was coming to her rescue, was rather very rich.

Mr Speaker, we must not allow such situations to happen. It takes away the very trust that exists between us as Leaders and I pray that this must never happen again. However, I am happy to announce that the Deputy Minority Leader, upon becoming aware of this situation, swiftly reacted to it and Mr Speaker has also swiftly responded to the memo from the Deputy Minority Leader, all aimed at resolving this matter. I am happy with the content of Mr Speaker's

response, which response gives me great relief, that indeed there is still an opportunity for us to jaw-jaw and to resolve situations in this House.

Mr Speaker, let me thank Parliamentary Service staff, led by the Clerk to Parliament, for their support. What would life be without them? We thank them for their industry.

Mr Speaker, to the Marshall and his able team, I say to them, thank you for supporting us as a Parliament. Not the least, let me also thank the media. They have often stayed with us at long hours and carried our views to the people.

Mr Speaker, now back to this House. The First Deputy Speaker and the Second Deputy Speaker, in many situations, were the ones presiding. Mr Speaker, we also thank you. There were times that the Minority disagreed with you, but I believe that in the spirit of democracy, we have managed to move on. Let me also thank Colleagues in Leadership; the Majority and the Minority Leaderships.

Let me thank them for supporting the cause of democracy in this House. As we go on our vacation, let me remind Colleagues that family first. If all of us will be healthy and would have the right mental health to do our work as Members of Parliament, we must keep the home at peace. Let us find time for our family, our children, our spouses, and our partners. Let us find time for the extended family and let us check our health.

Mr Speaker, we too often get busy with our work and forget about our health. Let us not be afraid to go for check-ups. Let us spend time to relax, but also be mindful of the mandate of the people who have given us this opportunity. May God bless our homeland, Ghana, and make it great and strong.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, before calling on the Majority Leader to give his closing remarks, let me make this announcement.

ANNOUNCEMENT

Preparations for the Second Edition of the Democracy Cup, 2025

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, following the successful launch of the second edition of the Democracy Cup, I wish to bring to your attention, some important updates regarding the schedule of activities to mark the event.

The main event, which will feature a thrilling derby between city arch-rivals Accra House of Oak and the Great Olympics, will take place on Friday, 29th August, 2025, at the University of Ghana Sports Stadium. As part of the day's activities, we are excited to announce a curtain-raiser match between Parliament and the Judiciary. Negotiations for this match are far advanced, and we are

hopeful of a fruitful collaboration with the Judiciary, with the involvement of the acting Chief Justice.

Parliament's team will be captained by Mr Mahama Ayariga. [*Hear! Hear!*] The Judiciary is yet to select their captain, but we are confident in our ability to compete when they bring their team. Hon Members who are interested in participating in the curtain-raiser match, and who believe they have the requisite soccer prowess, are kindly requested to contact their respective Whips to be included in the team.

We intend to begin training in earnest during the upcoming recess. Hon Members, although the Democracy Cup will be played during the recess, you are reminded to mark the events in your calendars accordingly. Your participation and support are essential to the success of this event.

Thank you.

1.12p.m.

There is an appeal for the women to play, at least, 10 minutes. So, that is granted.

Hon Majority Leader, you now have the floor.

Closing Remarks

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I am most grateful for this opportunity to make this brief remark as this honourable House draws down the curtains on this Second

Meeting of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament.

This Meeting, which commenced on Tuesday, 27th May, 2025, comes to a close today, Friday, 1st August, 2025, to allow Hon Members to take a break from the arduous plenary work. I describe it as arduous because, during this Meeting, the House held 43 Sittings within a 10-week period. Some Sittings were held on Saturdays and most Sittings even travelled very late into the night. As we are departing, a number of Committees will still be working and, most importantly, the Public Accounts Committee will be very active and busy during the recess period. Committees also use this period to engage in site visits, monitoring and evaluation, stakeholder engagements, among others.

As Hon Members of this House, we understand that the recess period is never a break from parliamentary duties as it may appear to the public. Recess provides us the opportunity to visit and interact with our constituents to listen to their concerns and views on issues of governance and nation building, share meaningful insights, and receive the needed feedback from them. This period also provides us with ample time to spend with our families and loved ones – something we barely get to do due to the demands of the job.

Over the past few months, we have had the opportunity to engage in fierce and rigorous debates, considered a number of Bills, some under the certificate of urgency, reviewed government policies, presented

Statements, and posed Questions, mostly urgent, on matters of national importance. The Committees have also been very busy and active during this Meeting.

Among the Bills presented include the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) Bill, 2025 which has been passed; the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 was withdrawn; then the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 was subsequently passed; the Public Holidays and Commemorative Days (Amendment) Bill, 2025 has been passed; the Social Protection Bill was withdrawn; then a new Social Protection Bill, 2025 has been passed; the Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025 has been referred to the Finance Committee; the University for Development Studies Bill, 2025 has been passed; the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 is still at the Consideration Stage; the Ghana Medical Trust Bill, 2025, which is the famous MahamaCares Programme, has been passed; the Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) (No. 2) Bill, 2025 has been passed; the Road Maintenance Trust Fund Bill, 2025 has been passed; and the Securities and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025 has been referred to the Committee on Security and Intelligence.

The various Instruments were also presented: the Environmental Protection, Refrigeration and Air Conditioning Certificate Regulations 2025; the Environmental Assessment Regulations, 2025; Environmental Protection Management of Ozone Depleting Substances; Halocarbon Alternatives

and their Products Regulations, 2025; the Environmental Protection Effluent Regulations, 2025; Environmental Protection Air Quality Management Regulations, 2025; Environmental Protection Petroleum Regulations, 2025; Immigration Service (Amendment) Regulations, 2025; Public-Private Partnership Regulations, 2025; Fees and Charges Miscellaneous Provisions (Amendment) Regulations 2025; Revenue Administration Regulations, 2025; Judicial Service Terms and Conditions of Service Regulations, 2025. Mr Speaker, as you can see, a lot of work has been done focusing on dealing with our numerous environmental challenges.

Mr Speaker, the Appointments Committee, in discharging its mandate, vetted and submitted its Report to the Plenary for the approval of four Deputy Ministers to different portfolios in government. The nominations by the President that were approved by the House were Hon Dorcas Toffey, MP for Jomoro, as Deputy Minister for Transport; Hon James Gyakyee Quayson, MP for Assin North, as Deputy Minister for Foreign Affairs; Hon Mohammed Adam Sukparu, MP for Sissala West, as Deputy Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations; and Hon Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah, MP Essikadu-Ketan, Deputy Minister for Health. It must be emphasised that these nominations were unanimously approved by the House. We, therefore, wish them the best in their deputy ministerial roles as they work to support the President to deliver on his mandate to the people.

Mr Speaker, the House was privileged to host the Hon Minister for Finance, former Minority and Majority Leader of this august House, the indefatigable Dr Ato Baah Forson to deliver the well-received Mid-Year Budget Review for 2025 on behalf of the President of the Republic of Ghana, H. E. John Dramani Mahama.

The Mid-Year Review clearly outlined the efforts of the Government to stabilise the economy, restructure external debt, and renew key sectors like banking and infrastructure with focal attention on fiscal discipline, efficiency and accountability.

Inflation, which was hovering around 23.8 per cent as of December, 2024, has been brought down drastically to 13.7 per cent, which is an unprecedented economic achievement. The stabilisation of the cedi, which was trading at around GH¢16 to US\$1 dollar has appreciated to around GH¢11 to US\$1, which is a 42.6 per cent gain, easing import costs.

The foreign reserves of the country have swelled to US\$11.1 billion, that is 4.8 months' import cover, up from the three-month baseline. GDP has also surged by 5.3 per cent and that exceeded the 4.4 per cent full-year projection. These are signs of a promising future and a better Ghana to come under the distinguished leadership of H. E. John Dramani Mahama and the National Democratic Congress (NDC). The Mid-Year Budget Review, 2025 has been debated upon by this House at length, so I will give no further comment.

Mr Speaker, something monumental happened in this House. Mr Speaker, this House had the unprecedented privilege to host the Indian Prime Minister, H. E. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who came before us and addressed this Parliament and outlined Indian Foreign Policy in relation to Africa. I must say that, subsequent to his address, I have met several Indians, in-country and abroad and they all indicate that Indians all over the world watched and saw what happened in this House and, of course, they were excited to see that the Members of this House were very excited about the Indian culture and wearing Indian dresses and Indian fashion and they were very impressed with the speech of the their Prime Minister in this House.

1.22 p.m.

Indeed, it gave this House a global visibility and I think that we will in future encourage such visits by visiting foreign heads of states.

Mr Speaker, our female national team, the Black Queens, made us all proud when they won bronze medal from their participation in the 2024 Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON) in Morocco. The team surprised Ghanaians by their outstanding performance. Even though I have congratulated them earlier, I will still use this opportunity to urge them not to rest on their laurels and continue to shine forth in their future games. We assure them of the full support of Parliament and would work in their interest to ensure they continue to make the nation proud.

Yesterday, Mr Speaker, I represented this House at the Mövenpick Ambassador Hotel for the launch of a fund in the support of the National League. I assure them that parliamentarians in their various regions will participate in the fundraising effort to raise about US\$11 million to support the development of soccer in this country. Mr Speaker, I will use this opportunity to urge all of us as we go around engaging in the fundraising effort, to participate and assist us identify potential funding sources for the development of soccer and football in the country.

That said, Mr Speaker, I am pleased to inform the House that the Northern Caucus has been launched with the aim of unifying all Members of Parliament from the five northern regions to put their arsenals together in championing development in the northern part of our country. The maiden Northern Development Conference, a gathering that brought political leaders, traditional authorities, Civil Society Organisations and development partners together, has been held in Tamale following the launch of the Caucus here in Parliament, to draw a road map for the sustainable and inclusive development of the northern regions.

Mr Speaker, on a rather solemn note, death unfortunately befell this House in the early hours of 7th July, 2025 through the sudden demise of Hon Ernest Kumi who represented the good people of Akwatia. This was a young man of 40 years with so much potential and a promising future. His dedication and

passion for parliamentary duties, even as a first-time Member of Parliament (MP), was unrivalled and there is no doubt that his untimely death is a great loss to this House.

The nation again woke up to the news of the passing of the Ghanaian legendary musician and high-life icon, Mr Charles Kwadwo Fosu, also known as (a.k.a.) Daddy Lumba, which sadly occurred on 26th July, 2025. These deaths are poignant reminders of the fleeting nature of the life we live here on earth. I will take this opportunity to wish their gentle souls peaceful rest and beseech their families and loved ones to find consolation in the Lord, because only he is our comforter. May their souls and the souls of the faithful departed continue to rest in the bosom of our Maker.

Mr Speaker, absenteeism and lateness to the Chamber by some Members continue to be a plaguing issue affecting the smooth conduct of Business by this august House. We must be cognisant of the fact that we are assigned a responsibility to ensure that the country's parliamentary democracy is held to high standards by becoming a benchmark on the continent. I therefore urge Colleagues, that as we go, let us take a good rest. Let us make sure we clear our private programmes, and when Parliament is resuming, to dedicate the period for parliamentary Business and not have to try to pair them and then in the process, miss out on attendance to this Chamber.

Mr Speaker, the Minority Leader, in his closing remarks, raised a number of

issues and it is only fair for me to provide some basic responses.

Mr Speaker, he raised the issue of *galamsey*. I must admit that as a country we must be united in the fight against *galamsey*. It is a problem that has plagued our society. In the last four years, *galamsey* was a major problem. Our rivers were largely polluted and there was digging everywhere. I was even shocked a few weeks ago when I was driving from Kumasi to Accra and saw that in some communities, there was digging even right behind a Police Station building. Right behind a police station building, people were digging for gold.

Mr Speaker, this Government, upon assumption of office, has put in place a number of measures aimed at decisively dealing with the problem of *galamsey* and the pollution of our river bodies. Quite recently, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources commissioned 1,000 blue water guards. Those 1,000 blue water guards are already working and turning our water bodies, which had become brown, to blue. In due course, the various polluted rivers will be cleaned. We will begin to see blue water, flowing in our rivers and not the brown and milky water that was flowing in them in 2024.

We are also overhauling the licencing regime. Just last week, 907 licences were announced and people were being asked to come and rectify all their licences. This was so that we will have them on record, documented with their owners and their sites, so we can deploy the

requisite expertise to monitor activities at those 907 small-scale mining sites. Mr Speaker, there is a well-coordinated fight against illegal mining led by the National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS). They are fighting illegal mining.

Mr Speaker, Cabinet has approved a well-refined cooperative mining programme to deal with the problem of illegal mining. Indeed, Cabinet has also voted significant amounts of money for alternative livelihoods. We would recall that yesterday in our closing debate on the Mid-Year Budget Review, we recounted the various increments in social intervention, all meant to complement efforts that we are putting in place at driving people out of illegal mining sites, and giving them alternative livelihoods to support them.

Mr Speaker, there is an effective coordination in the importation of excavators. I want to report to this House that under the New Patriotic Party (NPP), between 2023 and 2024, they arrested only 845 illegal miners and prosecuted only 35 persons. Within six months, the NDC government has arrested 1,345 people and most of them are being processed for court. Mr Speaker, we have seized 425 excavators, and those 425 excavators are still held by the Government of Ghana, and none of them is missing. Mr Speaker, at the port, we are monitoring the importation of excavators, and over 1,000 excavators are being held at the port.

There is coordinated work between the Minerals Commission, Driver and

Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA), and Ghana's Customs Service. Now, when one imports an excavator, he will have to justify the reason for the importation.

1.32 p.m.

One will have to show that he has a government contract that requires the use of an excavator, or show that they have a mining concession or lease that requires the use of the excavator and we will also install trackers on the excavators and the movement of the excavators will be geofenced so when the excavators are moved or where the excavators are operating will be monitored by the Minerals Commission, the DVLA and Customs. Because many of them cannot justify the importation of the excavators, we have over 1,000 excavators held up at the port. So, the fight against illegal mining and *galamsey* is continuing unabated and relentlessly by this Government.

The Minority Leader mentioned attack on businessmen. Mr Speaker, there is no attack on businessmen in this country. The persons that he mentioned are people that I personally know. When businessmen and state agencies have issues and they are being addressed using appropriate legal mechanisms, let us not politicise them.

Mr Speaker, he talked about electricity tariffs. Indeed, when he says in one vein that we need to rationalise our energy sector, and yet he criticises any effort to engage in cost recovery when it comes to

the production and sale of electricity, then it becomes very contradictory.

Mr Speaker, he also talked about investigative agencies using bail as a tool for punishing people who are being prosecuted. What I can say is that, this House should not be used to intimidate investigative agencies. The Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) was established by law, and EOCO was established by a law enacted by this Parliament or previous Parliaments so that they can carry out a specific mandate. Indeed, the Office of the Special Prosecutor (OSP) was established by the New Patriotic Party (NPP) Government, and the law was enacted.

The Special Prosecutor was appointed by the Government of the NPP when they were in office to exercise mandates that this Parliament gave them. I think that in all the legislation that we have established, we have clearly spelt out that citizens have rights, and when those rights are being violated, they have access to our courts to go and vindicate their rights. I think that it is a height of hypocrisy for us to enact such fine laws, establish those institutions, and when they are exercising their responsibilities and their mandates, for us to sit in this House and criticise them and try to undermine them in the exercise of their legitimate duties. Mr Speaker, those who feel aggrieved by those institutions know where to go to; they know the road to where the court buildings are, and they can afford lawyers to vindicate their rights.

The Minority Leader also spoke about the Pan-African Parliament and the ECOWAS Parliament delegations that were constituted by this House. Mr Speaker, what I can say about that simply is that this House has appropriately passed Resolutions, taking decisions on the composition of our delegations to the Pan-African Parliament and the ECOWAS Parliament. And I believe that any revocation of the decision of Parliament has to be based on another Resolution of this House changing that decision. Otherwise, the decision remains the decision of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, lastly, an important event occurred and I was hoping to make a Statement on that, but due to the constraints of time, I never got to make a Statement on that. I am sure many of us read social studies and history, either senior high school or those days in secondary school, O-level or A-level at sixth form, or even in the university. And we all remember the famous Bond of 1844, which was the Bond that really began colonialism in the then Gold Coast, which is now Ghana. I am happy to announce that last week the National Archives of the United Kingdom brought to this Parliament a copy of the original Bond of 1844.

And we now have that. We now have a copy in our archives for viewing. Yes, a copy of the original copy was brought here and given to the Speaker to be kept in our National Archives. So, all those who want to see the original copy of the Bond of 1844 can walk to the Parliamentary Archives and they will see a copy of the original Bond. I urge the

students who visit us any time they come to pass through our archives and view the copy of the Bond of 1844.

Mr Speaker, as we proceed on recess, I will urge Hon Colleagues to prioritise their health and general well-being. In spite of our busy and tight schedules, we must find time to rest and spend quality time with our families. While the work we do is important, taking care of ourselves and spending time with family is equally important. Our Parliament, since its inception in 1993, has been inundated by so many preventable deaths, and it is time we prioritise our general health and well-being, even as we serve the people.

I will conclude by expressing my appreciation to the Rt Hon Speaker, his able Deputies, Hon Colleagues in the Leadership, and the entire House for making us have a successful meeting.

To the Clerk, to Parliament, and his hardworking staff, I say a big thank you for being there to provide the needed procedural advice and technical support to service us to be able to carry out our mandate here. You are the silent heroes, and I truly appreciate you and your work, Clerk and your team.

To the Parliamentary Press Corps, I say thank you for choosing to be our partners on this journey. I would also like to thank the security personnel in Parliament who have stepped up their game. And these days, because we sometimes close very late, you see them loitering around, guarding our vehicles, watching over our cars, and then our

offices, and making sure that generally we are safe, even as we stay here until very late.

I say thank you all, and may God bless us. May God bless our homeland, Ghana.

And then also, during this Sitting, we began the live broadcast of Parliamentary proceedings on our channel on GTV. Let me thank the GTV team, the Director-General, and his team for providing us with that facility. Even though we made some investment, they generously gave us a channel, and now Parliamentary proceedings are broadcast live, and I think that a lot more people are following proceedings of Parliament.

I want to urge Colleagues, during recess, we need to populate the channel with content. So once in a while, the Parliamentary Broadcast Department will be inviting you, even during recess, for media engagement, so that we can have content to populate our TV channel. In addition, all Committees that will be sitting during the recess should also inform the Broadcasting Team of Parliament, so that they can cover the proceedings of the various Committees. Not just the Public Accounts Committee, every other Committee.

And I know that many Committees have referrals, and during the recess, they will be meeting over their referrals. Please communicate to the Broadcasting Team of Parliament, so that they can cover those ones, and they can use those materials as content, in order that our Channel will not be boring, and without footages during the recess.

On that note, Mr Speaker, I thank you all, God bless this Parliament, God bless Ghana, and may you all get home safely and return to the next Meeting of Parliament in good health. I thank you very much. [*Hear! Hear!*] [**Some Members of the Majority:** Leader oo! Leader!]

1.44 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker (Mr Bernard Ahiafor) *on behalf of the Speaker:* Hon Members, today marks the end of the Second Meeting of the first Session of the Ninth Parliament of the Fourth Republic. We are grateful to God for keeping us alive and shepherding us throughout this period.

I wish to express my sincere appreciation to all Hon Members for your dedication, patriotism and unwavering commitment to the Business of the House. Over the course of the Meeting, held between May and August, Parliament convened a total of 43 Sittings. During this time, the House diligently exercised its legislative, oversight and representative functions, transacting significant Businesses and deliberating on matters of national interest. Among the key highlights of this Meeting are the following:

Major Constitutional Business

On Thursday, 24th July, 2025, the Hon Minister for Finance presented the Mid-Year Review of the Budget Statement and economic policy for the 2025 financial year. It outlined five points strategy aimed at curbing inflation and

stabilising the economy through prudent fiscal management, targeted agriculture investment, improved monetary coordination and enhanced utility pricing mechanism.

Nominations by the President

The House successfully vetted and approved the nominations of seven Justices of the Supreme Court and four Deputy Ministers of State, fulfilling our constitutional mandate under Article 144 of the 1992 Constitution. I commend the Appointments Committee for its professionalism and the House for its vigilance.

Questions and Ministerial Accountability

In all, 497 Questions were admitted and processed. Out of these, 297 were asked and answered. They comprise of 242 Oral Questions and 55 Urgent Questions. This reflects our deep commitment to ensuring accountability, transparency and responsiveness from the executives.

Bills

During the course of the meeting, 13 Bills were presented, out of which eight were passed. One at Consideration Stage, two at Committee level and two rescinded. These include the following:

1. The Energy Sector Levies (Amendment) Bill, 2025, passed.
2. Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, withdrawn on 8th July, 2025.

3. Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, passed.
4. Public Holidays and Commemorative Days Amendment Bill, 2025, passed.
5. Social Protection Bill, 2025, withdrawn on 28th July 2025.
6. Social Protection Bill, 2025, passed.
7. Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025, referred to Finance Committee.
8. University for Development Studies Bill, 2025, passed.
9. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025, at Consideration Stage.
10. Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, passed.
11. Energy Sector Levy (Amendment) No. 2 Bill, 2025, passed.
12. Road Maintenance Trust Fund Bill, 2025, passed.
13. Security and Intelligence Bill, 2025, referred to Committee on Security and Intelligence.

Instruments Presented

Eleven Instruments were presented to the House during the Meeting, of which six came into force. However, two

Instruments, namely the Environmental Protection, Mining in Forest Reserves (Amendment) Regulations, 2025, and the Corporate Insolvency and Restructuring Regulations, 2025, which were presented during the first Meeting, came into force in this Meeting.

Statements and Business Statements

During the Meeting, 73 Statements by Members and Ministers on various issues were taken. A number of them were referred to relevant Committees for consideration and report. In addition, the House also adopted 10 Business Statements to guide its weekly activities.

Resolutions

The House, in accordance with Articles 75, 181 and 268 of the 1992 Constitution, where applicable, considered and approved by resolution the following:

1. Membership of Pan-African Parliament.
2. Membership of ECOWAS Parliament.
3. Seven Treaties, Protocols and Conventions.
4. Two Financial Agreements.
5. Five Mining Leases.
6. 131 Timber Utilisation Contracts.

Approval and Disbursement Formula

The House considered and approved the 2025 National Health Insurance Fund Formula.

Other Businesses

The following categories of Businesses were presented to the House and accordingly referred to the appropriate Committee for consideration and report: 16 Budget Performance Reports, 11 Auditor-General's Reports, five Mining Leases Agreement, five Annual Reports, 212 Audit Committees Reports and 131 Timber Utilisation Contracts.

1.52 p.m.

Challenging Moments

Despite these achievements, blended with the historic visits to the House by the Prime Minister of India, which affirmed the deepening diplomatic and parliamentary cooperation between the two nations, our Parliament unfortunately witnessed some moment of pain and sorrow.

Painful loss of a Member

We were profoundly saddened by the untimely passing of our Colleague,

Hon Ernest Yaw Kumi, the Member of Parliament for Akwatia, who passed away on 7th July, 2025, at the youthful age of 40. His demise, attributed to heart failure, is a painful reminder of the demanding nature of our calling. As a House, we must begin earnest

discussions on comprehensive healthcare support programmes, tailored to the unique pressure of our parliamentary work.

Electoral Integrity

We also took note of the recent electoral dispute in Ablekuma North, during the re-run of the parliamentary election. The incident involving the former Member of Parliament, Hon Mavis Hawa Koomson, must renew our collective commitment to legal reforms, institutional accountability, and the promotion of peaceful democratic processes. This House unequivocally condemned all forms of political violence and reaffirmed its dedication to safeguarding electoral integrity.

Tribute and Acknowledgements

Permit me, however, to acknowledge your efforts, commitment, and contributions to making this Second Meeting generally successful. I extend heartfelt gratitude to the First and Second Deputy Speakers for their dedication and hard work and competence in presiding over proceedings in my absence. To the Leadership of the House, on both Sides, I commend your efforts, even as I remind you that Parliament is not a courtroom, but a political institution built on deliberations, negotiations, and consensus building.

To the Clerk to Parliament, Deputy Clerk, and the entire staff of the Parliamentary Service, your procedural rigour and technical expertise remain an unseen pillar that uphold our daily work.

To our media partners, especially members of the Parliamentary Press Corps, your diligent reportage and commitment to public information enhance democratic transparency and civic engagement. This House acknowledges your vital role and pledges continuous support.

As we rise today, let us remember that recess is not a vacation. It is a return to the people we represent. I urge all Hon Members to use this period to reconnect with constituents, undertake field oversight and deepen parliamentary democracy. Let us embrace our responsibilities with renewed purpose and conviction.

This Meeting has demonstrated what is possible when we work together, transcending partisan interests to serve the greater good. Let us carry forward the spirit of consensus building, national unity, and public service that has defined this section. May we return reinvigorated, ready to confront new challenges and seize new opportunities for the benefit of all Ghanaians. May God bless you all; may God bless our Parliament, and may God bless the Republic of Ghana.

Hon Members, with these few words, I, hereby, proceed to adjourn the House *sine die*—[Hear! Hear!]*—*Thank you very much.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned sine die at 1.59 p.m.

